

Youssef Elsayyad

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EDUCATION

McMaster University

Sep 2024 – Jun 2028

Bachelor of Engineering, Software Engineering

Hamilton, ON

- GPA: 3.6
- Coursework: COMPSCI 3IS3: Information Security, SFWRENG 3SH3: Operating Systems, SFWRENG 2AA4: Software Design

EXPERIENCE

APTDefend

Jun 2026 – Present

Junior Software Developer

Remote (Poland)

- Shipped production code for a paid standalone module deployed to 50+ clients, owning features end to end from ticket to release and post-deployment support.
- Built backend services in Python and Django with Redis for caching and background task queuing across a multi-tenant client base.
- Integrated AI/LLM parsing to convert unstructured client documents into structured, validated data, replacing manual entry steps in the customer workflow.
- Developed responsive Angular interfaces with the CoreUI component library, delivering client dashboards and data visualizations for the product.
- Adopted a full DevOps workflow on a distributed remote team: Kubernetes-orchestrated containers, GitLab CI/CD for automated build and deploy, and Slack-based release and incident coordination.

YesWeHack

Mar 2026 – Present

Security Researcher

Remote

- Conducted penetration testing that escalated a SQL injection flaw from a single injectable parameter to server-side command execution, resulting in a critical-severity finding patched by the vendor.
- Identified and validated two IDOR vulnerabilities exposing unauthorized access to other users' records through controlled multi-account testing, then documented each finding with CVSS scoring and OWASP Top 10 / CWE mapping to support vulnerability management.
- Engineered a Python script to support reconnaissance and vulnerability analysis by enumerating object references at scale, quantifying mass-impact exposure across thousands of records, and delivering a reproducible proof of concept.

HackerOne

Sep 2021 – Present

Security Researcher

Remote

- Disclosed 100+ vulnerabilities with documented CVEs and CVSS scores across major web platforms and government bug bounty programs, earning over \$30,000 USD in bounties from the US Department of Defense, Vimeo, Dailymotion, and Roblox / Guilded.
- Findings span IDOR, stored XSS, SQL injection, RCE, source code disclosure, privilege escalation, authentication bypass, and business-logic flaws, each mapped to OWASP Top 10 and CWE classifications and aligned with NIST framework controls to enable prioritized remediation.
- Built Python tooling for proof-of-concept generation and exploit validation, giving vendor security teams reproducible artifacts and incident response playbook steps that accelerated containment and escalation.
- Reverse-engineered JavaScript bundles with Chrome DevTools and static analysis to map authentication flows and hidden API surfaces, uncovering undocumented endpoints later patched by vendors, and authored the reports translating that risk for non-security stakeholders.

PROJECTS

Security Research Blog | elsayyad.github.io/bounty-blog

2026 – Present

- Publish technical writeups on coordinated CVE disclosures, documenting vulnerability reproduction steps, CVSS-based risk analysis, root causes, and remediation recommendations.

TryHackMe | tryhackme.com/p/agentgeneric

- Completed 116 hands-on rooms spanning web application exploitation, networking, and cryptography.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages & Data: Python, Bash, Java, SQL, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MariaDB, Redis, C#, TypeScript

Frameworks & Libraries: Django, Angular, CoreUI, REST/GraphQL APIs, AI / LLM integration and parsing

Security & Networking Tools: Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, OWASP Top 10, JavaScript bundle analysis, HTTP/REST/GraphQL, session management, coordinated disclosure, Networks, Penetration Testing, Security Testing Methodologies

Security Frameworks & Practices: CIA Triad, CVE, CVSS Scores, ISO 27001, NIST Framework, Incident Response, Cybersecurity Fundamentals, Vulnerability Management, eJPT

Development & DevOps: Git, GitHub, GitHub Actions, GitLab, GitLab CI/CD, Kubernetes, Docker, Linux, Kali, Debian, Agile workflows, Slack, AI-assisted development tools

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ | July 2026

Android App Hacking – Black Belt Edition | Udemy, 54 hours | Dec 2025